



Hope Party

Party Constitution

Ratified As Of March 4th, 2026

Last Amended September 15th, 2026

Preamble

We the students of the University of Florida, for the purposes of repairing the well-documented century-long damage to Student Government caused by Florida Blue Key and its affiliates, representing the members of the Student Body in Student Government and the broader world, forming a true Indie party to honor the legacy of all those before us, and fighting for a better Gator Nation, do hereby establish and accept this document as the Constitution of the Hope Party.

Article I. Name

The name of this Party will be the “Hope Party”, hereafter referred to as “the Party”. The Party shall also be permitted to adopt any such slogans, monikers, logos, graphics, or abbreviations as it sees fit.

Article II. Organization Affiliation

Hope Party is a Student Government Political Party and agrees to be bound by the Student Body Statutes. Through registering with the University, our Party agrees to follow its policies and operate on campus with access and/or eligibility for specific campus benefits.

Article III. Purpose

The primary goal of the Hope Party shall be to improve student government. It shall accomplish this through:

- Nominating and assisting in the election of Hope candidates for the offices of President, Vice President, and Treasurer of the UF Student Government,
- Nominating and assisting in the election of Hope candidates for offices in the UF Student Senate,
- Filing and arguing cases in the Student Government Judicial Branch;
- Keeping archival, historical, and literary records of Student Government’s activities;
- Working with current Hope candidates and officers to help write legislation and complete action in the University of Florida Student Government for the greater good of the students at the aforementioned university; and,
- Any other means as the Executive Board feels necessary.

Article IV. Compliance Statement

The Hope Party shall comply with all local, state and federal laws, as well as all University of Florida regulations, policies, and procedures. Such compliance includes but is not limited to the University's regulations related to Non-Discrimination, Sexual Harassment (including sexual misconduct, dating violence, domestic violence, and stalking), Hazing, Commercial Activity, Student Government Student Body Statutes, and Student Leader Eligibility.

Article V. University Regulations

Section A. Non-Discrimination

Hope Party agrees that it will not discriminate on the basis of race, creed, color, religion, age, disability, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity and expression, marital status, national origin, political opinions or affiliations, genetic information and veteran status as protected under the Vietnam Era Veterans' Readjustment Assistance Act. Discrimination on the basis of the protected classes described in University of Florida Regulation 1.006 (Non-Discrimination/Harassment/Invasion of Privacy Policies) is prohibited.

Section B. Sexual Harassment

Hope Party agrees that it will not engage in any activity that is unwelcome conduct of sexual nature that creates a hostile environment. Behaviors that could create a hostile environment include sexual harassment (which could include inappropriate sexual comments), sexual misconduct, dating violence, domestic violence, and stalking and repeated instances of cyber abuse. Sexual harassment as described in University of Florida Regulation 1.006 (Non-Discrimination/Harassment/Invasion of Privacy Policy) is prohibited.

Section C. Hazing

Hope Party agrees that it will not initiate, support, or encourage any events or situations that recklessly, by design, or intentionally endanger the mental or physical health or safety of a student for any purpose including but not limited to initiation or admission into or affiliation with any student group or organization. Hazing as defined in the University of Florida Regulation 1.0081 (Prohibition of Hazing; Procedures and Penalties) and 4.040 (Student Honor Code and Student Conduct Code) is prohibited. If found responsible for hazing, sanctions may be imposed against the organization, its leaders and/or members.

Section D. Responsibility to Report

The University of Florida identifies Responsible Employees and Campus Security Authorities to support the health, safety, and wellbeing of campus. If Hope Party or its members become aware of any such conduct described in this article, they must report it immediately to staff in Student Activities and Involvement, the Director of Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution (352-392-1261, sccr@ufsa.ufl.edu), the University's Title IX Coordinator (*Lauren Wallace*, j.d.titleix@ufl.edu), the Student Government Advisor (*Jerome Scott II*, jerome.scott@ufl.edu), the Student Government Program Coordinator (*Elliot Fus*, efus@ufl.edu), or to the Student Government Supervisor of Elections (*Makena Romero*, elections@sg.ufl.edu).

Article VI. Membership

Membership in the Party is open to enrolled students at the University of Florida. Non-enrolled students, spouses, faculty, and staff may be associate members; however, they may not vote or hold office. All members and associate members are free to leave and disassociate without fear of retribution, retaliation, or harassment.

Article VII. Bylaws

Hope Party may elect to maintain separate bylaws document to outline the day-to-day operations of the organization and to clarify policies and procedures otherwise not included in the previous articles. Bylaws and/or other guiding documents may not take precedence over the requirements sent forth by local, state, and federal laws, the University of Florida's regulations, policies, and procedures, and the Student Engagement constitution requirements.

Amendments and changes may be made to the bylaws and shall be consistent with the Student Engagement approved constitution on file and Student Engagement's constitution requirements. Should the organization transition leadership, all bylaws and guiding documents will be transitioned to new student organization leaders and/or advisor(s).

Hope Party agrees to provide all unaltered bylaws and guiding documents and/or clarify its procedures in writing to any University of Florida student, faculty, or staff upon written request to the Operations Chair.

Article VIII. General Membership

Section A. Powers Vested and Meetings

It shall be within the powers of the general membership to elect the officers of the party, to recall and remove, to create bylaws not in contravention of this Constitution, and to have final democratic control over the Party.

These powers shall be exercised at general meetings, which shall occur at least monthly outside of the election season as defined in S.B.S. 700.4(l), immediately prior to the informational meeting hosted under S.B.S. 713.0, and at least twice-monthly the election season as defined in S.B.S. 700.4(l). General meetings may also be held at the call of the Executive Board, or by petition by 20% of the membership.

Quorum at any general meeting shall be ten percent of the membership, rounded up. Meetings shall be chaired by a member selected by the Executive Board.

Section B. Joining

No student may be a member if they are affiliated with an organization designated by the Executive Board as presenting a direct organizational conflict of interest, subject to appeal to the General Body.

The Executive Board shall circulate an application form and may admit any member by a two-thirds vote. A member may also be admitted by a majority vote of the general party membership at any party meeting.

Section C. Suspension & Removal

A motion to suspend or remove any member from the Party may be made with signatures from five party members or the Ethics & Accountability Chair. The member subject to suspension or removal shall be given notice of the allegation and an opportunity to address the General Body prior to the vote, and the vote shall occur by two-thirds majority.

By majority vote of the Executive Board, any member may be suspended until the next General Body Meeting.

No member may be suspended consecutively for the same issue without a vote of the general body. A suspended member shall lose all membership rights during the suspension period. The member subject to removal or suspension shall be given notice of the allegation and an opportunity to address the General Body prior to the vote.

If you wish to leave the party general membership, you may simply inform the Membership Director. All members are free to leave and disassociate without fear of retribution, retaliation, or harassment.

The Party may adopt bylaws concerning the removal of inactive membership.

Section D. Associate Membership

In the case where membership in the party would either cause conflicts with University rules and regulations, or at the choice of the relevant person, they may be admitted to Hope Party as an associate member. Associate members are forbidden from voting and holding office; however, they may participate in discussions at General Body Meetings and Party conventions, as well as act in an advisory role to a member of the Executive Board at the request of said board member.

Section E. Non-Member Affiliated Senators

Senators who affiliate themselves with the Party without being a member of the Party shall not be members of the Party.

Article IX. Candidacy

Section A. Legislative Branch

Candidates for Senate races shall “slate”, as defined by S.B.S. 733.o, to be considered for candidacy. The Executive Board shall nominate slated and qualified candidates to appear on the final ballot proceeding interviews. Candidates who are not party members must first become party members to be eligible.

Section B. Executive Branch

Candidates for the Executive Branch (Student Body President, Vice President, and Treasurer) must submit their written intent to run to the Executive Board no later than the Tuesday occurring five weeks before the last Tuesday in February. Presidential candidates must have a vice president selected, and treasurer candidates may run on their own.

The election for the party’s executive candidates in the Spring shall be held immediately prior to the informational meeting hosted under S.B.S. 713.o. These elections will be done using San Francisco RCV of all candidates or candidate groups. Ties shall be decided by coin flip, with the student with the lower UFID selecting the side they wish for.

In order to run for the executive branch as a member of Hope Party, you must have been a member of Hope for at least one previous semester before the Spring campaign season.

Section C. Binding

All candidates who seek and accept the nomination of the Hope Party for the Legislative or Executive Branch shall, when acting in their capacity as a Hope candidate or officeholder in Student Government, be bound by duly adopted decisions and positions of the Party.

Article X. Executive Board

Section A. Executive Board

The Executive Board shall be the highest body of the Party, subordinate to the party membership. It shall have the role of coordinating party membership and duly executing the goals of the Party. The Executive Board represents the Party as a whole and is responsible for directing the work of the Party. It is responsible for carrying out the political platform and decisions adopted by the Party, and for enforcing the Party Constitution. The Executive Board may not override the duly decided will of the Party. Any member of the executive board must also be eligible to be a party officer as specified in Section B.

Section B. Party Officers

The Hope Party Executive Board shall select, on or before the first day of classes each semester, the Party President and the Party Vice President for registration purposes. The Operations Chair shall be the Party Treasurer for registration and legal purposes. These officers shall have no additional roles added outside of those granted by the Student Body Statutes and their official roles in the Executive Board. These designations shall not constitute additional Executive Board seats and shall not alter the internal responsibilities of the Executive Board members holding them.

The President, Vice President, and Treasurer agree to relinquish their positions without argument upon their removal.

For the purposes of the Student Government or the Elections committee, these officers are our officers. Therefore, they must follow all of the following criteria:

- Be enrolled as a degree-seeking student as defined by the Office of the University Registrar
- Meet requirements for registration and academic standing as follows:
 - Undergraduate Students must be registered for at least six credits in the Fall and Spring semesters (Spring and Summer for Innovation Academy Students), have a minimum 2.0 cumulative grade point average, cannot be on academic warning or academic probation, and otherwise must be in good academic standing;

- Graduate and professional Students must meet the requirements for part-time status for the graduate professional program in which they are enrolled, or be registered for six credits if appointed to a one-third or half-time graduate assistantship, have a minimum 3.0 cumulative grade point average, or at least the minimum grade point average required to remain in good standing with the graduate or professional program in which they are enrolled, cannot be on academic warning or academic probation, and otherwise must be in good academic standing; and
- Postgraduate Students must be enrolled for at least six credits and may not serve more than one semester while in postgraduate status.
- Have no delinquent financial obligations to UF;
- Remain in good standing with UF throughout the duration of the elected term; and
- Meet any additional requirements, including enrollment and academic standing requirements established by the Vice President for Student Life.

Section C. List of Roles

The Party's Executive Board shall consist of the following members:

- Policy Chair, who handles all policies and helps review and make decisions on legislation. They are also responsible for the political education of new members.
- Communications Chair, who handles all social media, messaging, public relations, and branding.
- Operations Chair, who handles party budgets and books meetings and events. For the purposes of registration, they are the Party Treasurer.
- Membership Chair, who shall hold responsibility for keeping accurate records of membership, and shall coordinate membership-related work.
- Ethics & Accountability Chair, who handles ethics complaints, violations of the Constitution and/or Bylaws, and audits. The Ethics and Accountability chair shall have the power to discipline members for actions contrary to the values of the Party.
- Party Leader, who represents the Party in the ways listed and determined by the Rules and Procedures of the UF Student Senate. They shall have the duty of coordinating work within the Senate. They shall also be referred to as the Chuck Schumer of the Party. In the event of a tie, the vote of the Party Leader shall be disregarded.

The Executive Board may also appoint other members as non-voting members to the Executive Board upon a two-thirds vote.

Section D. Elections

For the role of Party Leader, they shall be elected in a method determined by the Rules and Procedures of the UF Student Senate.

For the other roles, the election shall be held by ranked ballot in-person tallied using the method of San Francisco Ranked Choice Voting. Ties shall be decided by coin flip, with the student with the lower UFID selecting the side they wish for.

Section E. Removals

Any member of the Executive Board may be removed by a two-thirds vote of the general body. If any seat is vacant at any time, the Executive Board shall notify the general body of the open seat, and they shall conduct a vote on a replacement in the same manner as regular elections at the next GBM.

Section F. Succession

If there is a position which is currently vacant, the Executive Board may appoint a temporary officer to hold the position.

Article XI. Miscellaneous

Section A. Funding

As a Student Government political party, this organization's funding must follow the Student Government Election Codes. The Operations Chair shall be in charge of ensuring compliance with these codes. This chair shall keep the party budget and will report this budget at the request of any member of the Student Body. They shall also ensure this information is accessible from a public link on the party website.

Section B. Parliamentary Authority

The rules contained in the current edition of Robert's Rules of Order Newly Revised shall govern the Party in all cases to which they are applicable and in which they are not inconsistent with this Constitution, the Bylaws of the Party, and any special rules of order the Party may adopt.

Section C. Bylaws Continuity

These bylaws shall continue to be valid and the Party shall continue to exist between election seasons as defined in S.B.S. 700.4(l) and while not officially registered; however, between election seasons, it may not engage in Campaigning as defined in S.B.S. 700.4(D), 700.4(E), 761.1, and Watch Party v. Supervisor of Elections, 4 S.C. 49-50 (November 4, 2024).

Section D. Hybrid Meetings

Hybrid virtual/in-person meetings are authorized for the purposes of this body, and the members present via the virtual meeting may be counted towards quorum. No general meeting shall be held where no physical space is available, however any location may be used as a physical space.

Article XII. Dissolution

In the event where a vote to invoke this clause at a quorate meeting succeeds by an eighty-percent threshold or where the total membership of the Party is less than six; the following procedure shall be carried out as to be determined by the remaining membership in the meeting where the clause has been invoked:

At the time of dissolution, after all outstanding debts are paid, Hope Party will leave any assets and outstanding funds to the Civic Media Center & Stetson Kennedy Library Inc. (a 501(c)(3) nonprofit organization), or their successor, or another organization as determined by the General Body prior to dissolution.

All social media accounts, email accounts, and other digital entities associated, managed, or controlled by the Party shall be archived once dissolution has been invoked. All confidential public records shall be disposed of by the Executive Board.

Article XIII. Amendments

This constitution may be amended at any regular meeting of the Party that meets an elevated quorum of one-third of the Party. The amendment shall be voted on and approved by a two-thirds ($\frac{2}{3}$) majority vote of members attending the meeting. The text of the proposed amendment must be submitted to the Executive Board and made public three days before the said meeting.